



**NATION
BUILDERS**

SPIRIT OF INDIA SPECIAL

APT WASTE MANAGEMENT COMPANY Established 2002

Three municipalities in south Chennai set up an integrated solid waste management project. With a private-public partnership, they are trying to find a solution to one of urban India's greatest nightmares, garbage.

CLEAN MISSION

Every day Chennai produces 4,000 tonnes of garbage that rots on the roads and in the lanes, choking drains and posing a hazard to life besides being an eyesore. But the three municipalities of Alandur, Pallavaram and Tambaram in south Chennai have found a way to deal with this ever-growing problem. They will recycle garbage in a traditional yet scientifically sound way. As Tambaram Municipality Chairman E. Mani, 52, says, "This integrated solid waste management project is the first of its kind in Tamil Nadu."

Approximately 250 tonnes of garbage is generated in these municipalities everyday—Alandur (80 tonnes), Pallavaram (86 tonnes) and Tambaram (78 tonnes). The garbage is collected through primary collection. The municipalities insist on segregation at the source. After materials like plastic are sent for recycling, organic waste is used for vermi composting and the remaining solid waste is used as landfill.

This integrated solid waste management project was proposed under the Union government's Jawaharlal Nehru National Urban Renewal Mission scheme at a cost of Rs 44.21 crore. It is implemented through a public-private partnership with

1.2 lakh tonnes
is the
estimated
amount of
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N.S. Prema 50, Tambaram Municipal Commissioner

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Hydroair Tectonics, Mumbai, which has completed more than 200 environment-friendly projects. Hydroair Tectonics bears 50 per cent of the cost, with the state Government investing the other half. Alandur, Pallavaram, and Tambaram municipalities have formed the APT Waste Management Company with the Pallavaram Municipal Commissioner Asokan as the nodal officer. "We have already bought the required number of vehicles and bins according to the specifics and have distributed them in the wards," says Tambaram Municipal Commissioner N.S. Prema.

The state Government has given the nod to lease 2.99 lakh sq m of land for 20 years to Hydroair Tectonics. The

company requires land for establishing transfer stations, material recovery sheds and for setting up the compost yard and sanitary landfill facilities. "Despite trying to provide maximum facilities, municipalities are not able to solve the garbage problem. So we have roped in private partners. The project is awaiting the nod by the Chennai Metropolitan Development Authority and Tamil Nadu Pollution Control Board and will take off soon at the field level," says Prema. As the composting yards are near Meenambakkam airport, composting will be done in enclosed sheds to avoid attracting birds. In the long term, the company plans to even produce power through the refuse derived fuel formation method.

by Adhi Valliappan